Treasury securities.[234] In general, Brazilians view greater voice for emerging economies in global financial governance as highly desirable.

### *Brazilian Foreign Policy Traditions: Western, Idealistic—and Southern*

Brazilian cooperation with the BRICS in financial statecraft also emerges from Brazil's overarching foreign policy traditions.[235] Brazil is a Western country, by dint of language, religion, culture, and long (if interrupted) democratic and liberal political traditions. It also boasts an independent foreign policy tradition that a North American might characterize as idealist: dispute resolution by peaceful means is given high priority. Many Brazilians, especially but not exclusively those whose politics lean center-left, are deeply suspicious of realist power politics, and they often view the United States as the main practitioner of a bullying style of international relations, particularly given its long history of Cold War–era interventions in Latin America and the Caribbean. Although Brazil lacks major or enduring conflicts of interest with the incumbent powers, it has been frustrated with being dismissed as unimportant by the United States and its G7 partners.

Brazil actively promotes South-South cooperation, a label that Brazilians employ to encompass all its international relations with emerging, reemerging, and developing powers—everyone except the global North. Strengthening ties with its regional neighbors, most also newly democratic, was among the first foreign policy goals of Brazil's new civilian leaders following the end of the twenty-year military regime in 1985. The Common Market of the South (Mercosur, which also encompasses Uruguay and Paraguay) was a joint project of Brazilian President José Sarney and Argentine President Raúl Alfonsín, each of whom hoped that deeper regional economic links would discourage ambitious military officers from intervening in politics. Ties with the hemispheric great power, the United States, continued to be the most important foreign policy relationship, but by the mid-1990s, under center-right President Fernando Henrique Cardoso (January 1995–December 2002), Brazil felt sufficiently confident to try to expand beyond Mercosur to construct new multilateral links with all of South America, as well to reach out to Western Europe.

President da Silva continued and expanded Cardoso-era initiatives, although the rhetoric now tilted moderately left. Under da Silva, Brazil